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DO YOU LIVE IN THE UK ALREADY BUT CANNOT FIND CERTIFICATE OF SPONSORSHIP
 RELOCATE TO IRELAND EASILY CALL OR MESSAGE +44 75 916 839 24

UK Care Worker: Moving to Ireland vs Staying in the UK- THIS GUIDE WAS PREPARED BY MR SAMUEL +44 75 916 89 24 (Immigration Consultant)

Feature	Moving to Ireland (General Employment Permit – GEP)	Staying in UK (CoS / Health & Care Visa)
	FREE to the worker (employer pays the General Employment Permit fee)	
	The worker provides personal documents (passport, CV, proof of experience).	
Visa / Permit Fee	Employer submits supporting documents on behalf of the worker to the Department of Enterprise, Trade and Employment of IRELAND Worker GEP visa is issued within 12 weeks Worker books a train from London Euston to Dublin to start work	£715–£1,220 (Skilled Worker / Health & Care visa, paid by worker)
Immigration Health Surcharge	Not required	£624/year (mandatory)
Employer Sponsorship	Minimal admin only: job offer + supporting documents + Labour Market Needs Test (LMNT)	Employer must issue CoS (rare for care roles now)

Feature	Moving to Ireland (General Employment Permit – GEP)	Staying in UK (CoS / Health & Care Visa)
Required?		
Competition / Availability	Moderate – high demand in Ireland	Extremely high – very limited CoS availability
Total Approx. Out-of-Pocket (Worker)	FREE	£1,400–£2,000+ (visa + IHS)
Ease of Process	Simple, legal, predictable	Difficult, competitive, uncertain
Job Security / Long-Term Stay	Initial permit lasts 2 years (renewable, €1,000 per renewal, usually employer-paid). After 3 years of continuous work , eligible to apply for Irish citizenship / passport (€175 application + optional €950 passport fee). Employer involvement is minimal; workers are fully trained, ensuring continuity and high standards.	Initial visa typically 3 years . Renewal/extension: £715–£1,220 + £624/year IHS. Citizenship: typically requires 5+ years legal stay , ILR £2,389, UK citizenship £1,330. Extremely competitive; CoS required from employer.

CALL MR SAMUEL (Immigration Consultant) ON +44 75 916 839 24

Key Takeaways

- **Ireland is cheaper, faster, and predictable:** FREE initial permit to worker, high demand for UK-trained carers, minimal admin for employers, clear path to citizenship in ~3 years.
- **UK is expensive, highly competitive, and uncertain:** Visa + health surcharge costs £1,400–£2,000+, CoS hard to get, and citizenship takes 6+ years.